

Ellis Island and Immigration

Connect the people, places, and changes of Ellis Island, where about 12 million immigrants entered the United States between 1892 and 1954.

? Historical challenge

Between 1892 and 1954, about 12 million people arrived at Ellis Island in New York Harbor, hoping to start new lives in America. Who came, where did they land and settle, and what changed because of them? Map how people, place, and change connect.

1 Investigate

SOURCES 1

History of Ellis Island from 1892 to 1954 – National Park Service

SECONDARY SOURCE

How the immigration station worked and changed over 62 years.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- When did Ellis Island open and close?
- About how many people passed through it?

SOURCES 2

Ellis Island – Immigration and Relocation in U.S. History (Library of Congress)

SECONDARY SOURCE

The inspection process arrivals went through, with primary sources.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What happened to someone arriving at Ellis Island?
- How might the wait have felt?

SOURCES 3

Ellis Island Passenger Manifests – National Archives (Prologue)

PRIMARY SOURCE

Ship passenger lists recording names, ages, jobs, and home countries.

[Open source ↗](#)

Investigate:

- What information did the manifests record?
- How do these records help families today?

2 Build your Event Map

Fill in the organizer from the evidence. Mark information with ①②③ to show which source it came from. Leave a space blank if the sources don't tell you.

THE EVENT		
Ellis Island and Immigration		
1892–1954 New York Harbor		
Who? 	Where? 	What changed?
How were people, place, and change connected? 		
Sources 1	Sources 2	Sources 3

3 Compare

- Compare your three lenses with a partner. Did you connect the same people to the same places and changes?
- Which change do you think mattered most to a newly arrived family? Why?

4 Expand

Your teacher will add context, vocabulary, and information the sources leave out. Add it to your map.

5 Revise

Go back to your Event Map. Add, correct, or reorganize based on the discussion.

6 Conclude

In your own words, explain how people, place, and change connect at Ellis Island. Use at least one detail from each lens and one source.